

V06 PHYSICAL ACTIVITY OPPORTUNITIES | O (MAX : 2 PT)

Intent : Encourage physical activity and exercise through no-cost physical activity opportunities for occupants.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to provide no-cost physical activity opportunities led by a qualified physical activity professional.

Issue : Nearly a quarter of the global population fails to achieve physical activity guidelines and is considered physically inactive.¹ Key determinants of physical activity behavior include time, convenience, motivation, self-efficacy, weather conditions, travel and family obligations, fear of injury, lack of social support and environmental barriers such as availability of sidewalks, parks and bicycle lanes.^{2,3} In a review conducted by the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, two studies highlighted economic benefits of workplace programs, including reduced healthcare costs, decreased costs and days lost due to disability, reduced absenteeism and increased productivity.⁴

Solutions :

The workplace is considered an effective platform to reach a broad segment of the adult population.⁵ Therefore, workplace wellness programs and offerings are considered great steps toward decreasing barriers to physical activity engagement among employees.⁶ The Community Preventive Services Task Force recommends worksite programs that make physical activity more readily available (e.g., providing health club memberships, changing insurance benefits, providing opportunities to be physically active) as a strategy to improve physical activity engagement.⁷

Similar to the workplace, schools represent a ubiquitous platform to reach adolescents and youth.⁸ The Community Preventive Services Task Force recommends classroom-based teaching strategies and physical education curricula that incorporate activity as promising strategies to increase physical activity among adolescents.⁹ When considering physical activity education and programming, it is vital to consider the needs of the population that the project serves. Events and education should be relevant to the community (i.e., ability and age-appropriate). Projects should also seek to solicit on-going feedback from their population and make an effort to consider feedback in revisions to programmatic offerings.

PART 1 OFFER PHYSICAL ACTIVITY OPPORTUNITIES (MAX : 2 PT)

For All Spaces:

No cost physical activity opportunities are available to regular occupants and meet the following requirements:

- Programming is appropriate for the project population (e.g., age, ability, culture).
- Programming is offered by a qualified physical activity professional either in-person within a 200 m walk distance of the project boundary or virtually through live programming.
- As applicable, physical activity opportunities are not withheld as a form of punishment for early childhood education, primary or secondary school students.⁹
- Programming is offered at the following frequencies, as applicable:

Tier	Early Childhood Education, Primary and Secondary School Students (as applicable)	All other regular occupants	Points
1	At least one 60-minute event per week	At least one 30-minute event per week	1
2	> 60 minutes per school day ¹⁰	> 150 minutes per week ¹⁰	2

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